

Section B: Composition

45 marks

Candidates are required to submit **one** of the following types of composition lasting not more than **four** minutes:

1. Vocal composition

- A setting of a short poem or other text, normally of not more than **four stanzas** or **120 words**.

2. Programme music

- An instrumental composition for **four** or more instruments, interpreting a narrative text, character or visual image.

3. Film/TV composition

- Music to accompany a storyboard, DVD clip, TV title theme, cartoon or advertisement.

Whichever option is chosen, candidates define their own brief for their composition, which they must explain fully in a commentary.

The instruments used for the chosen composition may be:

- acoustic;
- amplified;
- a combination of acoustic and amplified instruments; or
- electro-acoustic.

Candidates should be able to demonstrate:

- effective choice and use of materials;
- technical and structural control;
- expressive use of the medium; and
- clear communication and realisation of intentions.

The submission must include the following:

- a recording in either the intended instrumentation or reduced as a piano or synthesized/sequenced demonstration; and
- **either** a full score in a form appropriate to the style (to serve as the principal examination document)
- **or** a full commentary on the methods of mixing and producing the master recording (which becomes the principal examination document assessed on production values).

Unit Content

Section A: Stylistic Techniques

The principal focus of this section of the unit is the Area of Study **Tonality**. Each style requires a different range of techniques and vocabulary but all candidates are expected to develop an awareness of what is appropriate to a specific style in both language and texture. Specific aspects of the Area of Study **Tonality** are relevant to most of the styles. Where appropriate, opportunities may be taken to link candidates' work in this section to historical models offered in **Section B** of